

Notes on Computers

What is a Computer?

A computer is an electronic device that processes data according to a set of instructions called programs.

It can store, retrieve, and process information quickly and accurately.

Modern computers are used for both general-purpose and specialized tasks.

Uses of Computers

- Computers are used in education for e-learning and research.
- In offices, they are used for data entry, communication, and documentation.
- They are essential in banking for online transactions and record-keeping.
- In healthcare, computers help with patient records, diagnostics, and research.
- Computers are used in entertainment for gaming, movies, and music.
- In engineering, they are used for designing, simulation, and analysis.
- Computers enable global communication through email, social media, and video conferencing.

Advantages of Computers

- Computers perform tasks faster than humans.
- They store large amounts of data with easy access.
- They reduce human effort in repetitive and complex tasks.
- Computers improve accuracy and consistency.
- They support automation in various industries.

Disadvantages of Computers

- Over-dependence on computers can reduce human thinking skills.
- Excessive use may lead to health issues like eye strain or poor posture.
- Computers are vulnerable to hacking and data breaches.
- They can lead to job losses due to automation.
- Repairs and maintenance can be costly.

Operating System (OS)

An Operating System is system software that manages computer hardware and software resources.

It acts as an interface between the user and the computer hardware.

Examples include Windows, macOS, Linux, and Android.

The OS handles tasks like memory management, file storage, input/output processing, and security.